Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 57

Major 7, dominant 7, minor 7, half-diminished, shells, ii-V-I, and functional voice leading

4 QUALITIES | 56 SILENT FORMS | 796 ATTACKS

Level 56 established natural-minor and raised-seventh dominant function. Level 57 adds the seventh to each triad, introduces practical movable four-note voicings, reduces them to shell voicings, and connects thirds and sevenths through major ii-V-I, minor iiø-V-i, and A-blues progressions.

1. Hear the seventh

The seventh changes function and color: major 7, flat 7, or half-diminished tension.

2. Reduce to the shell

Root, third, and seventh identify most seventh-chord function. Add the fifth only when quality requires it.

3. Move voices, not blocks

Track thirds and sevenths by half step or common tone before adding roots, fifths, or rhythm patterns.

Four seventh-chord qualities

```
MAJOR 7          1-3-5-7       bright tonic / color chord
DOMINANT 7       1-3-5-b7      active dominant; tritone between 3 and b7
MINOR 7          1-b3-5-b7     minor tonic, predominant, modal color
MINOR 7 b5       1-b3-b5-b7    half-diminished predominant in minor

MAJOR ii-V-I     m7  -> 7  -> maj7
MINOR iiø-V-i    m7b5 -> 7 -> m7

SHELL LIMITATION: m7 and m7b5 share the same R-b3-b7 shell.
The flat fifth must be added or heard elsewhere to identify half-diminished quality.
```

Written workload

Module	Attacks
B - E-root families	112
C - A-root families	112
D - shell ladders	56
E - major ii-V-I	108
F - minor iiø-V-i	108
G - blues shells	108
H - arpeggio scans	64
I - capstones	128
TOTAL	796

Session protocol

Choose one full-voicing family, one shell progression, and one arpeggio or comping exercise. Form the chord silently, attack with minimum pressure, release fully, and name the third and seventh before moving. Use clean tone before gain.

SAFETY Barre only the strings required by the voicing. Rest between long family ladders and stop if the hand becomes painful.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 57

Seventh-chord formula atlas and movable-shape overview

E-ROOT + A-ROOT FAMILIES

THE THIRD SETS MAJOR OR MINOR; THE SEVENTH SETS MAJOR-7 OR FLAT-7 FUNCTION

Quality	Formula	Characteristic voices	Primary use
maj7	1-3-5-7	3 and 7	major tonic / color

E-root practical four-note voicings

Quality	Shape E-A-D-G-B-e	Role order
maj7	r x r+1 r+1 r x	R x 7 3 5 x
7	r x r r+1 r x	R x b7 3 5 x
m7	r x r r r x	R x b7 b3 5 x
ROOT MAP m7b5	F1 G3 A5 B7 C8 D10 E12 on low E. r x r r r-1 x	R x b7 b3 b5 x

A-root practical four-note voicings

Quality	Shape E-A-D-G-B-e	Role order
maj7	x r r+2 r+1 r+2 x	x R 5 7 3 x
7	x r r+2 r r+2 x	x R 5 b7 3 x
m7	x r r+2 r r+1 x	x R 5 b7 b3 x
ROOT MAP m7b5	B2 C3 D5 E7 F8 G10 A12 on A string. x r r+1 r r+1 x	x R b5 b7 b3 x

Quality-change mechanics at one root

```
maj7 -> 7      lower the seventh by one semitone
7    -> m7     lower the third by one semitone
m7   -> m7b5   lower the fifth by one semitone

E-root example at A:  Amaj7 5 x 6 6 5 x -> A7 5 x 5 6 5 x -> Am7 5 x 5 5 5 x -> Am7b5 5 x 5 5 4 x
A-root example at D:  Dmaj7 x 5 7 6 7 x -> D7 x 5 7 5 7 x -> Dm7 x 5 7 5 6 x -> Dm7b5 x 5 6 5 6 x
```

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 57

Module B - E-root major 7 and dominant 7 families

14 SHAPES | 56 ATTACKS

FORM SILENTLY; ATTACK FOUR QUARTER NOTES; RELEASE COMPLETELY BEFORE THE NEXT ROOT

The shape is movable. The chord spelling changes with the root, but the interval formula and string roles remain fixed. Use only the printed attack zone and mute both excluded strings.

E-root major 7 family

Chord	Shape	Spelling	Fingering
Fmaj7	1 x 2 2 1 x	F-A-C-E	1 x 2 3 1 x
Gmaj7	3 x 4 4 3 x	G-B-D-F#	1 x 2 3 1 x
Amaj7	5 x 6 6 5 x	A-C#-E-G#	1 x 2 3 1 x
Bmaj7	7 x 8 8 7 x	B-D#-F#-A#	1 x 2 3 1 x
Cmaj7	8 x 9 9 8 x	C-E-G-B	1 x 2 3 1 x
Dmaj7	10 x 11 11 10 x	D-F#-A-C#	1 x 2 3 1 x
Emaj7	12 x 13 13 12 x	E-G#-B-D#	1 x 2 3 1 x

EXERCISE 4 quarter-note attacks per shape; 28 attacks in this family.

E-root dominant 7 family

Chord	Shape	Spelling	Fingering
F7	1 x 1 2 1 x	F-A-C-Eb	1 x 1 2 1 x
G7	3 x 3 4 3 x	G-B-D-F	1 x 1 2 1 x
A7	5 x 5 6 5 x	A-C#-E-G	1 x 1 2 1 x
B7	7 x 7 8 7 x	B-D#-F#-A	1 x 1 2 1 x
C7	8 x 8 9 8 x	C-E-G-Bb	1 x 1 2 1 x
D7	10 x 10 11 10 x	D-F#-A-C	1 x 1 2 1 x
E7	12 x 12 13 12 x	E-G#-B-D	1 x 1 2 1 x

EXERCISE 4 quarter-note attacks per shape; 28 attacks in this family.

AUDIT Name root, third, fifth, and seventh before changing fret. Do not use the unused strings to hide a weak voicing.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 57

Module B - E-root minor 7 and half-diminished families

14 SHAPES | 56 ATTACKS

FORM SILENTLY; ATTACK FOUR QUARTER NOTES; RELEASE COMPLETELY BEFORE THE NEXT ROOT

The shape is movable. The chord spelling changes with the root, but the interval formula and string roles remain fixed. Use only the printed attack zone and mute both excluded strings.

E-root minor 7 family

Chord	Shape	Spelling	Fingering
Fm7	1 x 1 1 1 x	F-Ab-C-Eb	1 x 1 1 1 x
Gm7	3 x 3 3 3 x	G-Bb-D-F	1 x 1 1 1 x
Am7	5 x 5 5 5 x	A-C-E-G	1 x 1 1 1 x
Bm7	7 x 7 7 7 x	B-D-F#-A	1 x 1 1 1 x
Cm7	8 x 8 8 8 x	C-Eb-G-Bb	1 x 1 1 1 x
Dm7	10 x 10 10 10 x	D-F-A-C	1 x 1 1 1 x
Em7	12 x 12 12 12 x	E-G-B-D	1 x 1 1 1 x

EXERCISE 4 quarter-note attacks per shape; 28 attacks in this family.

E-root minor 7 flat 5 / half-diminished family

Chord	Shape	Spelling	Fingering
Fm7b5	1 x 1 1 0 x	F-Ab-Cb-Eb	2 x 3 3 1 x
Gm7b5	3 x 3 3 2 x	G-Bb-Db-F	2 x 3 3 1 x
Am7b5	5 x 5 5 4 x	A-C-Eb-G	2 x 3 3 1 x
Bm7b5	7 x 7 7 6 x	B-D-F-A	2 x 3 3 1 x
Cm7b5	8 x 8 8 7 x	C-Eb-Gb-Bb	2 x 3 3 1 x
Dm7b5	10 x 10 10 9 x	D-F-Ab-C	2 x 3 3 1 x
Em7b5	12 x 12 12 11 x	E-G-Bb-D	2 x 3 3 1 x

EXERCISE 4 quarter-note attacks per shape; 28 attacks in this family.

AUDIT Name root, third, fifth, and seventh before changing fret. Do not use the unused strings to hide a weak voicing.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 57

Module C - A-root major 7 and dominant 7 families

14 SHAPES | 56 ATTACKS

FORM SILENTLY; ATTACK FOUR QUARTER NOTES; RELEASE COMPLETELY BEFORE THE NEXT ROOT

The shape is movable. The chord spelling changes with the root, but the interval formula and string roles remain fixed. Use only the printed attack zone and mute both excluded strings.

A-root major 7 family

Chord	Shape	Spelling	Fingering
Bmaj7	x 2 4 3 4 x	B-D#-F#-A#	x 1 3 2 4 x
Cmaj7	x 3 5 4 5 x	C-E-G-B	x 1 3 2 4 x
Dmaj7	x 5 7 6 7 x	D-F#-A-C#	x 1 3 2 4 x
Emaj7	x 7 9 8 9 x	E-G#-B-D#	x 1 3 2 4 x
Fmaj7	x 8 10 9 10 x	F-A-C-E	x 1 3 2 4 x
Gmaj7	x 10 12 11 12 x	G-B-D-F#	x 1 3 2 4 x
Amaj7	x 12 14 13 14 x	A-C#-E-G#	x 1 3 2 4 x

EXERCISE 4 quarter-note attacks per shape; 28 attacks in this family.

A-root dominant 7 family

Chord	Shape	Spelling	Fingering
B7	x 2 4 2 4 x	B-D#-F#-A	x 1 3 1 4 x
C7	x 3 5 3 5 x	C-E-G-Bb	x 1 3 1 4 x
D7	x 5 7 5 7 x	D-F#-A-C	x 1 3 1 4 x
E7	x 7 9 7 9 x	E-G#-B-D	x 1 3 1 4 x
F7	x 8 10 8 10 x	F-A-C-Eb	x 1 3 1 4 x
G7	x 10 12 10 12 x	G-B-D-F	x 1 3 1 4 x
A7	x 12 14 12 14 x	A-C#-E-G	x 1 3 1 4 x

EXERCISE 4 quarter-note attacks per shape; 28 attacks in this family.

AUDIT Name root, third, fifth, and seventh before changing fret. Do not use the unused strings to hide a weak voicing.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 57

Module C - A-root minor 7 and half-diminished families

14 SHAPES | 56 ATTACKS

FORM SILENTLY; ATTACK FOUR QUARTER NOTES; RELEASE COMPLETELY BEFORE THE NEXT ROOT

The shape is movable. The chord spelling changes with the root, but the interval formula and string roles remain fixed. Use only the printed attack zone and mute both excluded strings.

A-root minor 7 family

Chord	Shape	Spelling	Fingering
Bm7	x 2 4 2 3 x	B-D-F#-A	x 1 3 1 2 x
Cm7	x 3 5 3 4 x	C-Eb-G-Bb	x 1 3 1 2 x
Dm7	x 5 7 5 6 x	D-F-A-C	x 1 3 1 2 x
Em7	x 7 9 7 8 x	E-G-B-D	x 1 3 1 2 x
Fm7	x 8 10 8 9 x	F-Ab-C-Eb	x 1 3 1 2 x
Gm7	x 10 12 10 11 x	G-Bb-D-F	x 1 3 1 2 x
Am7	x 12 14 12 13 x	A-C-E-G	x 1 3 1 2 x

EXERCISE 4 quarter-note attacks per shape; 28 attacks in this family.

A-root minor 7 flat 5 / half-diminished family

Chord	Shape	Spelling	Fingering
Bm7b5	x 2 3 2 3 x	B-D-F-A	x 1 2 1 3 x
Cm7b5	x 3 4 3 4 x	C-Eb-Gb-Bb	x 1 2 1 3 x
Dm7b5	x 5 6 5 6 x	D-F-Ab-C	x 1 2 1 3 x
Em7b5	x 7 8 7 8 x	E-G-Bb-D	x 1 2 1 3 x
Fm7b5	x 8 9 8 9 x	F-Ab-Cb-Eb	x 1 2 1 3 x
Gm7b5	x 10 11 10 11 x	G-Bb-Db-F	x 1 2 1 3 x
Am7b5	x 12 13 12 13 x	A-C-Eb-G	x 1 2 1 3 x

EXERCISE 4 quarter-note attacks per shape; 28 attacks in this family.

AUDIT Name root, third, fifth, and seventh before changing fret. Do not use the unused strings to hide a weak voicing.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 57

Module D - root-third-seventh shell voicings and the half-diminished limitation

SHELL ATLAS | MINIMUM FUNCTIONAL VOICES

ROOT + THIRD + SEVENTH IDENTIFY maj7, 7, AND m7; m7b5 REQUIRES THE FLAT FIFTH FOR FULL QUALITY

Shell voicings reduce physical pressure and expose voice leading. They are ideal for comping, but a three-note m7 shell and m7b5 shell are identical because the fifth is omitted. Add the flat fifth or rely on the bass and melody when half-diminished quality must be explicit.

E-root shells on E-D-G

Quality	Formula	Roles
maj7	r x r+1 r+1 x x	R x 7 3 x x
7	r x r r+1 x x	R x b7 3 x x
m7	r x r r x x	R x b7 b3 x x
m7b5	same shell as m7	add B-string r-1 for b5

A-root shells on A-G-B

Quality	Formula	Roles
maj7	x r x r+1 r+2 x	x R x 7 3 x
7	x r x r r+2 x	x R x b7 3 x
m7	x r x r r+1 x	x R x b7 b3 x
m7b5	same shell as m7	add D-string r+1 for b5

Rootless guide-tone dyads

```
maj7: 3 + 7
7:    3 + b7
m7:   b3 + b7
m7b5:b3 + b7  (same dyad as m7)
```

When to omit the fifth

The perfect fifth often adds weight but little function. Omit it when the third and seventh need to move clearly. Preserve or restore the flat fifth when distinguishing m7b5 from m7.

MUTING A shell is complete only when the unused strings remain silent during a full six-string audit.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 57

Module D - same-root seventh-chord quality ladders

2 LADDERS | 56 ATTACKS

CHANGE ONE QUALITY-DEFINING VOICE AT A TIME

Each seven-attack ladder descends from major 7 through dominant 7, minor 7, and half-diminished, then returns. Repeat each printed ladder four times without removing the root reference.

E-root A quality ladder

```
Order|maj7----7-------m7------m7b5----m7------7-------maj7----|

maj7  5 x 6 6 5 x

7     5 x 5 6 5 x

m7    5 x 5 5 5 x

m7b5  5 x 5 5 4 x

m7    5 x 5 5 5 x

7     5 x 5 6 5 x

maj7  5 x 6 6 5 x
```

COUNT 7 attacks x 4 repeats = 28.

A-root D quality ladder

```
Order|maj7----7-------m7------m7b5----m7------7-------maj7----|

maj7  x 5 7 6 7 x

7     x 5 7 5 7 x

m7    x 5 7 5 6 x

m7b5  x 5 6 5 6 x

m7    x 5 7 5 6 x

7     x 5 7 5 7 x

maj7  x 5 7 6 7 x
```

COUNT 7 attacks x 4 repeats = 28.

Silent transposition commands

- ☐ E-root: Fmaj7 -> F7 -> Fm7 -> Fm7b5
- ☐ E-root: Cmaj7 -> C7 -> Cm7 -> Cm7b5
- ☐ A-root: Emaj7 -> E7 -> Em7 -> Em7b5
- ☐ A-root: Gmaj7 -> G7 -> Gm7 -> Gm7b5

If a shape change sounds like a new root, stop and re-identify the stationary root note before continuing.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 57

Module E - major ii-V-I shell voicings

C / G / D MAJOR | 54 TONES

m7 -> 7 -> maj7 | TWO GUIDE-TONE VOICES MOVE BY COMMON TONE OR HALF STEP

Play four quarter-note shell attacks per chord: twelve attacks per key. Then play the lower and upper guide-tone lines separately: three attacks per line. The complete key cell contains eighteen attacks.

C major: Dm7 -> G7 -> Cmaj7

```
Chd|Dm7-------G7--------Cmaj7-----|
Rol|b3/b7-----b7/3------3/7-------|
  G|5---------4---------4---------|
  D|3---------3---------2---------|
```

```
LOWER VOICE
D|3--3--2--|
Role|b3--b7--3---|

UPPER VOICE
G|5--4--4--|
Role|b7--3---7---|
```

COUNT 12 shell attacks + 6 single-line attacks = 18.

G major: Am7 -> D7 -> Gmaj7

```
Chd|Am7-------D7--------Gmaj7-----|
Rol|b3/b7-----b7/3------3/7-------|
  G|12--------11--------11--------|
  D|10--------10--------9---------|
```

```
LOWER VOICE
D|10--10--9--|
Role|b3--b7--3---|

UPPER VOICE
G|12--11--11--|
Role|b7--3---7---|
```

COUNT 12 shell attacks + 6 single-line attacks = 18.

D major: Em7 -> A7 -> Dmaj7

```
Chd|Em7-------A7--------Dmaj7-----|
Rol|b3/b7-----b7/3------3/7-------|
  G|7---------6---------6---------|
  D|5---------5---------4---------|
```

```
LOWER VOICE
D|5--5--4--|
Role|b3--b7--3---|

UPPER VOICE
G|7--6--6--|
Role|b7--3---7---|
```

COUNT 12 shell attacks + 6 single-line attacks = 18.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 57

Module E - major ii-V-I shell voicings

A / E / F MAJOR | 54 TONES

m7 -> 7 -> maj7 | TWO GUIDE-TONE VOICES MOVE BY COMMON TONE OR HALF STEP

Play four quarter-note shell attacks per chord: twelve attacks per key. Then play the lower and upper guide-tone lines separately: three attacks per line. The complete key cell contains eighteen attacks.

A major: Bm7 -> E7 -> Amaj7

```
Chd|Bm7-------E7--------Amaj7-----|
Rol|b3/b7-----b7/3------3/7-------|
  G|14--------13--------13--------|
  D|12--------12--------11--------|
```

```
LOWER VOICE
D|12--12--11--|
Role|b3--b7--3---|

UPPER VOICE
G|14--13--13--|
Role|b7--3---7---|
```

COUNT 12 shell attacks + 6 single-line attacks = 18.

E major: F#m7 -> B7 -> Emaj7

```
Chd|F#m7------B7--------Emaj7-----|
Rol|b3/b7-----b7/3------3/7-------|
  G|9---------8---------8---------|
  D|7---------7---------6---------|
```

```
LOWER VOICE
D|7--7--6--|
Role|b3--b7--3---|

UPPER VOICE
G|9--8--8--|
Role|b7--3---7---|
```

COUNT 12 shell attacks + 6 single-line attacks = 18.

F major: Gm7 -> C7 -> Fmaj7

```
Chd|Gm7-------C7--------Fmaj7-----|
Rol|b3/b7-----b7/3------3/7-------|
  G|10--------9---------9---------|
  D|8---------8---------7---------|
```

```
LOWER VOICE
D|8--8--7--|
Role|b3--b7--3---|

UPPER VOICE
G|10--9--9--|
Role|b7--3---7---|
```

COUNT 12 shell attacks + 6 single-line attacks = 18.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 57

Module E - major ii-V-I voice-leading audit and circle capstone

6 KEYS | ROOTLESS FUNCTION

THE ii-V-I SHOULD REMAIN AUDIBLE WHEN ROOTS AND FIFTHS ARE REMOVED

Play the six printed ii-V-I cells in circle order. First use shells, then the lower line, then the upper line. Finally connect each Imaj7 directly to the next key's iim7 without stopping the pulse.

Key	ii-V-I	D-string voice	G-string voice	Movement
C	Dm7-G7-Cmaj7	3-3-2	5-4-4	common / half-step
G	Am7-D7-Gmaj7	10-10-9	12-11-11	common / half-step
D	Em7-A7-Dmaj7	5-5-4	7-6-6	common / half-step
A	Bm7-E7-Amaj7	12-12-11	14-13-13	common / half-step
E	F#m7-B7-Emaj7	7-7-6	9-8-8	common / half-step
F	Gm7-C7-Fmaj7	8-8-7	10-9-9	common / half-step

Circle order

```
C -> G -> D -> A -> E -> F
Dm7-G7-Cmaj7  ...  Gm7-C7-Fmaj7
```

Comping pass

Attack shell on beat 1; arpeggiate lower then upper guide tone on beats 2-3; release on beat 4. Twelve attacks per key.

EAR TEST Record the rootless shells. Identify the key center from the resolution into Imaj7.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 57

Module F - minor iiø-V-i shell voicings

A / E / B MINOR | 54 TONES

m7b5 -> 7 -> m7 | THE iiø SHELL REQUIRES A FLAT-FIFTH CHECK

Play four quarter-note shell attacks per chord, then both single guide-tone lines. Before the shell pass, form the printed full iiø voicing once so the flat-fifth quality is established in the ear.

A minor: Bm7b5 -> E7 -> Am7

iiø CHECK x 2 3 2 3 x

```
Chd|Bm7b5-----E7--------Am7-------|
Rol|b3/b7-----b7/3------b3/b7-----|
  G|14--------13--------12--------|
  D|12--------12--------10--------|
```

```
LOWER VOICE
D|12--12--10--|
Role|b3--b7--b3--|

UPPER VOICE
G|14--13--12--|
Role|b7--3---b7--|
```

COUNT 12 shell attacks + 6 single-line attacks = 18.

E minor: F#m7b5 -> B7 -> Em7

iiø CHECK x 9 10 9 10 x

```
Chd|F#m7b5----B7--------Em7-------|
Rol|b3/b7-----b7/3------b3/b7-----|
  G|9---------8---------7---------|
  D|7---------7---------5---------|
```

```
LOWER VOICE
D|7--7--5--|
Role|b3--b7--b3--|

UPPER VOICE
G|9--8--7--|
Role|b7--3---b7--|
```

COUNT 12 shell attacks + 6 single-line attacks = 18.

B minor: C#m7b5 -> F#7 -> Bm7

iiø CHECK x 4 5 4 5 x

```
Chd|C#m7b5----F#7-------Bm7-------|
Rol|b3/b7-----b7/3------b3/b7-----|
  G|16--------15--------14--------|
  D|14--------14--------12--------|
```

```
LOWER VOICE
D|14--14--12--|
Role|b3--b7--b3--|

UPPER VOICE
G|16--15--14--|
Role|b7--3---b7--|
```

COUNT 12 shell attacks + 6 single-line attacks = 18.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 57

Module F - minor iiø-V-i shell voicings

F# / C# / D MINOR | 54 TONES

m7b5 -> 7 -> m7 | THE iiø SHELL REQUIRES A FLAT-FIFTH CHECK

Play four quarter-note shell attacks per chord, then both single guide-tone lines. Before the shell pass, form the printed full iiø voicing once so the flat-fifth quality is established in the ear.

F# minor: G#m7b5 -> C#7 -> F#m7

iiø CHECK x 11 12 11 12 x

```
Chd|G#m7b5----C#7-------F#m7------|
Rol|b3/b7-----b7/3------b3/b7-----|
  G|11--------10--------9---------|
  D|9---------9---------7---------|
```

```
LOWER VOICE
D|9--9--7--|
Role|b3--b7--b3--|

UPPER VOICE
G|11--10--9--|
Role|b7--3---b7--|
```

COUNT 12 shell attacks + 6 single-line attacks = 18.

C# minor: D#m7b5 -> G#7 -> C#m7

iiø CHECK x 6 7 6 7 x

```
Chd|D#m7b5----G#7-------C#m7------|
Rol|b3/b7-----b7/3------b3/b7-----|
  G|18--------17--------16--------|
  D|16--------16--------14--------|
```

```
LOWER VOICE
D|16--16--14--|
Role|b3--b7--b3--|

UPPER VOICE
G|18--17--16--|
Role|b7--3---b7--|
```

COUNT 12 shell attacks + 6 single-line attacks = 18.

D minor: Em7b5 -> A7 -> Dm7

iiø CHECK x 7 8 7 8 x

```
Chd|Em7b5-----A7--------Dm7-------|
Rol|b3/b7-----b7/3------b3/b7-----|
  G|19--------18--------17--------|
  D|17--------17--------15--------|
```

```
LOWER VOICE
D|17--17--15--|
Role|b3--b7--b3--|

UPPER VOICE
G|19--18--17--|
Role|b7--3---b7--|
```

COUNT 12 shell attacks + 6 single-line attacks = 18.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 57

Module F - minor iiø-V-i voice leading and m7 versus m7b5 distinction

6 KEYS | FUNCTION BEFORE GRIP

iiø AND m7 SHARE b3 + b7; THE FLAT FIFTH DEFINES HALF-DIMINISHED QUALITY

The guide-tone dyad alone cannot distinguish iim7b5 from iim7. Hear or add the flat fifth before reducing to the shell. The V chord then supplies the raised seventh that resolves into the minor tonic.

Key	iiø-V-i	iiø full check	D voice	G voice
A	Bm7b5-E7-Am7	x 2 3 2 3 x	12-12-10	14-13-12
E	F#m7b5-B7-Em7	x 9 10 9 10 x	7-7-5	9-8-7
B	C#m7b5-F#7-Bm7	x 4 5 4 5 x	14-14-12	16-15-14
F#	G#m7b5-C#7-F#m7	x 11 12 11 12 x	9-9-7	11-10-9
C#	D#m7b5-G#7-C#m7	x 6 7 6 7 x	16-16-14	18-17-16
D	Em7b5-A7-Dm7	x 7 8 7 8 x	17-17-15	19-18-17

Two-stage iiø drill

1. Play the full four-note m7b5 voicing and sing the b5. 2. Remove the b5 and continue with the rootless guide-tone dyad.

Dominant-resolution drill

Hold the V third, sing the tonic, then resolve both guide voices into the minor i. Do not let the raised seventh remain as a permanent scale note.

EAR TEST Alternate m7 and m7b5 at the same root. The only changed voice is the fifth.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 57

Module G - A-blues dominant shell map in three registers

A7-D7-E7 | LOW / MIDDLE / HIGH

SHELLS REDUCE PRESSURE AND LEAVE ROOM FOR THE LEAD VOCABULARY FROM SECTION V

Use root-inclusive shells in the low register and rootless guide-tone dyads in the middle and high registers. Name the third and flat seventh before every chord change.

Low register - root-inclusive shells

A7

```
Str|E---A---D---G---B---e---|
Fre|5   x   5   6   x   x   |
Nte|A   x   G   C#  x   x   |
Rol|R   x   b7  3   x   x   |
```

D7

```
Str|E---A---D---G---B---e---|
Fre|x   5   x   5   7   x   |
Nte|x   D   x   C   F#  x   |
Rol|x   R   x   b7  3   x   |
```

E7

```
Str|E---A---D---G---B---e---|
Fre|x   7   x   7   9   x   |
Nte|x   E   x   D   G#  x   |
Rol|x   R   x   b7  3   x   |
```

Middle rootless dyads - D/G

Chord	Lower	Upper	Roles
A7	D11	G12	3 + b7
D7	D10	G11	b7 + 3
E7	D12	G13	b7 + 3

High rootless dyads - B/e

Chord	Lower	Upper	Roles
A7	B14	e15	3 + b7
D7	B13	e14	b7 + 3
E7	B15	e16	b7 + 3

Register connection

Bars 1-4: low shells. Bars 5-8: middle dyads. Bars 9-12: high dyads. The chord identity must remain equally clear when the root is removed. Add a bass root only when the ensemble needs it.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 57

Module G - A-blues shell-comping patterns and register-cycle capstone

108 ATTACKS | 12-BAR FORM

THE SAME SHELL MAP SUPPORTS SUSTAINED, BACKBEAT, SHUFFLE, AND ARPEGGIATED COMPING

Use the standard form | A7 A7 A7 A7 | D7 D7 A7 A7 | E7 D7 A7 E7 |. Keep the chord changes fixed while the attack pattern and register change.

Pass 1 - low sustained

REGISTER Low root-inclusive shells

GRID 1 attack per bar

12 attacks

Pass 2 - middle backbeats

REGISTER Middle rootless dyads

GRID attacks on beats 2 and 4

24 attacks

Pass 3 - high shuffle chops

REGISTER High rootless dyads

GRID shuffle pair on beats 2 and 4

24 attacks

Pass 4 - register-cycle capstone

REGISTER low bars 1-4; middle 5-8; high 9-12

GRID blocked shell + three-note arpeggio

48 attacks

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 57

Module H - seventh-chord arpeggio scans from practical voicings

8 SHAPES | 64 ATTACKS

LOW TO HIGH, REPEAT THE TOP NOTE, HIGH TO LOW - PRESERVE THE CHORD SPELLING

Arpeggiate each representative shape through its four active strings, then reverse. Say the chord role of every note. The repeated highest note begins the descending half of the eight-attack cell.

Amaj7 - E-root

```
Nte|A---G#--C#--E---E---C#--G#--A---|
Rol|R---7---3---5---5---3---7---R---|
  e|-------------------------------|
  B|-----------5---5---------------|
  G|--------6----------6-----------|
  D|----6-----------------6--------|
  A|-------------------------------|
  E|5---------------------------5---|
```

COUNT 8 attacks

A7 - E-root

```
Nte|A---G---C#--E---E---C#--G---A---|
Rol|R---b7--3---5---5---3---b7--R---|
  e|-------------------------------|
  B|-----------5---5---------------|
  G|--------6----------6-----------|
  D|----5-------------------5-------|
  A|-------------------------------|
  E|5---------------------------5---|
```

COUNT 8 attacks

Am7 - E-root

```
Nte|A---G---C---E---E---C---G---A---|
Rol|R---b7--b3--5---5---b3--b7--R---|
  e|-------------------------------|
  B|-----------5---5---------------|
  G|--------5----------5-----------|
  D|----5-------------------5-------|
  A|-------------------------------|
  E|5---------------------------5---|
```

COUNT 8 attacks

Am7b5 - E-root

```
Nte|A---G---C---Eb--Eb--C---G---A---|
Rol|R---b7--b3--b5--b5--b3--b7--R---|
  e|-------------------------------|
  B|-----------4---4---------------|
  G|--------5----------5-----------|
  D|----5-------------------5-------|
  A|-------------------------------|
  E|5---------------------------5---|
```

COUNT 8 attacks

Dmaj7 - A-root

```
Nte|D---A---C#--F#--F#--C#--A---D---|
Rol|R---5---7---3---3---7---5---R---|
  e|-------------------------------|
  B|-----------7---7---------------|
  G|--------6----------6-----------|
  D|----7-------------------7-------|
  A|5---------------------------5---|
  E|-------------------------------|
```

COUNT 8 attacks

D7 - A-root

```
Nte|D---A---C---F#--F#--C---A---D---|
Rol|R---5---b7--3---3---b7--5---R---|
  e|-------------------------------|
  B|-----------7---7---------------|
  G|--------5----------5-----------|
  D|----7-------------------7-------|
  A|5---------------------------5---|
  E|-------------------------------|
```

COUNT 8 attacks

Dm7 - A-root

```
Nte|D---A---C---F---F---C---A---D---|
Rol|R---5---b7--b3--b3--b7--5---R---|
  e|-------------------------------|
  B|-----------6---6---------------|
  G|--------5----------5-----------|
  D|----7-------------------7-------|
  A|5---------------------------5---|
  E|-------------------------------|
```

COUNT 8 attacks

Dm7b5 - A-root

```
Nte|D---Ab--C---F---F---C---Ab--D---|
Rol|R---b5--b7--b3--b3--b7--b5--R---|
  e|-------------------------------|
  B|-----------6---6---------------|
  G|--------5----------5-----------|
  D|----6-------------------6-------|
  A|5---------------------------5---|
  E|-------------------------------|
```

COUNT 8 attacks

Second pass: accent only the third and seventh. Third pass: omit the root attack and hear the remaining guide-tone function.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 57

Module I - major and minor sixteen-bar shell-voicing capstones

2 CAPSTONES | 128 ATTACKS

FOUR QUARTER-NOTE SHELL ATTACKS PER MEASURE

Each four-bar block contains ii-V-I-I or iiø-V-i-i. Announce the next key on beat 4 of the final tonic measure. Use the printed D/G guide-tone dyads; add the root only on the first pass.

Major capstone - four ii-V-I-I blocks

Bars 1-4: Dm7 | G7 | Cmaj7 | Cmaj7	`D/G: 3-5 | 3-4 | 2-4 | 2-4`
Bars 5-8: Am7 | D7 | Gmaj7 | Gmaj7	`D/G: 10-12 | 10-11 | 9-11 | 9-11`
Bars 9-12: Em7 | A7 | Dmaj7 | Dmaj7	`D/G: 5-7 | 5-6 | 4-6 | 4-6`
Bars 13-16: Bm7 | E7 | Amaj7 | Amaj7	`D/G: 12-14 | 12-13 | 11-13 | 11-13`

COUNT 16 bars x 4 attacks = 64.

Minor capstone - four iiø-V-i-i blocks

Bars 1-4: Bm7b5 | E7 | Am7 | Am7	`D/G: 12-14 | 12-13 | 10-12 | 10-12`
Bars 5-8: F#m7b5 | B7 | Em7 | Em7	`D/G: 7-9 | 7-8 | 5-7 | 5-7`
Bars 9-12: C#m7b5 | F#7 | Bm7 | Bm7	`D/G: 14-16 | 14-15 | 12-14 | 12-14`
Bars 13-16: Em7b5 | A7 | Dm7 | Dm7	`D/G: 17-19 | 17-18 | 15-17 | 15-17`

COUNT 16 bars x 4 attacks = 64. Play the full iiø voicing once before each new minor block.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 57

Ear training, random-quality commands, and error-repair laboratory

NO NEW ATTACK COUNT | REUSE PRIOR CELLS

HEAR THE QUALITY CHANGE BEFORE NAMING THE SHAPE

Quality-identification loop

Record maj7, 7, m7, and m7b5 at the same root in random order. Identify the quality, the altered voice, and whether the seventh is major or minor before checking the fretboard.

Shell-limit hearing test

Alternate m7 and m7b5 full voicings. Then remove the fifth from both. The shell should become identical. Restore the b5 and identify the half-diminished chord again.

Random command cards

- ☐ G7 E-root
- ☐ Cmaj7 A-root
- ☐ Bm7 A-root
- ☐ Em7b5 E-root
- ☐ Fmaj7 E-root
- ☐ Am7 A-root
- ☐ D7 A-root
- ☐ Gm7b5 A-root

Error diagnosis

WRONG 7TH	compare maj7 and b7 at one root
WRONG 3RD	switch major/minor without moving root
m7b5 SOUNDS m7	restore the flat fifth
SHELL BUZZ	barre fewer strings; release thumb pressure
VOICE JUMP	choose nearer octave or common tone
FORM LOSS	return to roots and count bars

Functional ear sequence

Major: sing the ii third, V third, and I third; then sing the ii seventh, V seventh, and I seventh. Minor: sing the iiø b5 before reducing to shells; then sing the raised dominant third resolving into the tonic.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 57

Practice progression, mastery gate, completion audit, and log

NEXT: SIXTEENTH-NOTE RHYTHM GUITAR

ADVANCE WHEN QUALITY, FUNCTION, AND VOICE LEADING REMAIN CLEAR UNDER REDUCED PRESSURE

Ten-phase progression

- [ ] 1. Spell four seventh qualities
- [ ] 2. Form E-root families silently
- [ ] 3. Form A-root families silently
- [ ] 4. Play both quality ladders
- [ ] 5. Reduce to shells
- [ ] 6. Major ii-V-I in six keys
- [ ] 7. Minor iiø-V-i in six keys
- [ ] 8. A-blues shell comping
- [ ] 9. Eight arpeggio scans
- [ ] 10. Two sixteen-bar capstones

Mastery gate before Level 58

- [ ] Name formulas and spellings
- [ ] 56 silent movable forms
- [ ] four quality changes at one root
- [ ] six major ii-V-I keys
- [ ] six minor iiø-V-i keys
- [ ] m7 versus m7b5 distinction
- [ ] A7-D7-E7 shell form
- [ ] eight arpeggio scans
- [ ] major and minor capstones
- [ ] two clean days

Advancement standard

Form every quality at random natural roots; play the guide-tone shells without fret searching; keep the major and minor cadences audible without roots; distinguish m7 from m7b5 by restoring the flat fifth; and complete both capstones with relaxed pressure and correct muting on two separate days.

Practice log

Date	Family / key	Quality / cadence	D/U	BPM	Clean?	Weak voice / shape	Next target

NEXT Level 58: sixteenth-note rhythm guitar, syncopation, dead strokes, ties, releases, and full-song comping capstone.